

BIP-39 Mapping Explained

Step 1: Generate Entropy

- 128 bits (for 12 words), 192 bits (for 18 words), or 256 bits (for 24 words).

Step 2: Add Checksum

- Compute SHA-256 of entropy.
- Take the first $(ENT / 32)$ bits as checksum.
- Append checksum to entropy.
- Example: 128 bits entropy + 4 checksum bits = 132 bits total.

Step 3: Split into 11-bit chunks

- Each BIP-39 word represents 11 bits (since $2^{11} = 2048$).
- $132 \text{ bits} \div 11 = 12 \text{ words}$.
- $264 \text{ bits} \div 11 = 24 \text{ words}$.
- Result: $N \times 11\text{-bit chunks}$.

Step 4: Convert each 11-bit chunk to an index

- Each chunk is a number 0–2047.
- Example:
 $00000000000 \rightarrow 0$
 $00000000001 \rightarrow 1$
 $11111111111 \rightarrow 2047$

Step 5: Map index $\rightarrow$ word

- Each index corresponds to a word in the BIP-39 wordlist.
- Wordlist length = 2048 words.
- Example:
Index 0 $\rightarrow$ abandon
Index 2047 $\rightarrow$ zoo

Step 6: Final Seed Phrase

- Sequence of 12 / 18 / 24 words.
- Last word contains checksum bits, so changing entropy alters the last word.
- Invalid phrases are detected when checksum doesn't match entropy.